The Milliard Bilpengő, the highest denomination note in this sequence (also the highest denomination note ever printed), was equal to a billion trillion Pengő, which astonishingly, was only worth about US 12 cents!

The Hungarian economy could only be stabilized by the introduction of a new currency, and therefore, on 1 August 1946, the Forint was reintroduced at a rate of 4,00,000,000,000,000,000,000,000,000,000 (400 octillion) = 4×10^{29} Pengő, dropping 29 zeros from the old currency.

The stabilization worked, and prices remained relatively stable in Hungary until the 1960s. And as for all the old Pengő, they were thrown away because they were worthless!

Two other instances of demonetization which were successful are noteworthy.

European Union

The first was the demonetization of European currencies when the Euro was introduced in 2002. This was a major and very complex demonetization as it involved introducing a new currency in 12 countries, while withdrawing their respective national currencies. This major demonetization was successfully implemented because of the painstaking planning that preceded the step and also because the old currencies remained convertible for an extended period of time.

Australia

In order to tackle the problems of both counterfeiting and wear and tear of the paper currency, Australia between 1992 and 1996 replaced all paper-based notes with polymer banknotes, after an initial trial in 1988.

As the objective of the demonetization was very specific, very well planned, and executed prudently over an extended period, it was